

*I can't disclose this idea because it will be stolen!*

*Will you sign my non-disclosure agreement before I tell you my idea?*

No, I won't sign your NDA, nor do I care about your idea. In the world of wealth, ideas are worthless yet treated like gold. I love how idea conjurers protect their ideas with great stewardship, careful to ensure they don't get into the hands of would-be thieves, not knowing that their ideas are already shared by hundreds of others. *The owner of an idea is not he who imagines it, but he who executes it.*

According to entrepreneur Derek Sivers (Sivers.org) ideas are just multipliers while execution represents actual money. Within our Fastlane chess game, ideas (pawns) are potential speed, while execution (the king) is the pressure applied to the accelerator. This relationship demonstrates how the coupling of a great idea (potential speed/strong pawns) is worthless when attached to weak execution (no acceleration pressure/weak king).

### **The Pawn: Idea (Potential Top Speed)**

Awful idea = 1 mph

Weak idea = 5 mph

So-so idea = 35 mph

Good idea = 65 mph

Great idea = 100 mph

Brilliant idea = 200 mph

### **The King: Execution (Accelerator Pressure)**

No execution = \$1

Weak execution = \$1,000

So-so execution = \$10,000

Good execution = \$100,000

Great execution = \$1,000,000

Brilliant execution = \$10,000,000

If you notice, a brilliant idea and no execution are worth all of 200 bucks. Awesome potential speed (idea) is married to weak accelerator pressure (execution). Yet a so-so idea with brilliant execution could be worth \$350 million. You see, it isn't about your ideas and their potential speed, *but about your execution!*

When I started my Web business, several other companies already had established Web sites. Instead of reasoning, "Someone is already doing it," I executed better and became the leader in my industry. Was my idea spectacular? No. It was an OK idea, but I executed better than the competition. After my revenue model became successful and copied unmercifully, did my business decline and fail? No, because the idea wasn't the lynchpin to success, *it was execution.* Competitors